

Distributed Intelligence Initiative

Keeping capable AI available to everyone, on hardware people own and beyond any single off-switch.

A growing number of people and organizations now depend on AI for real work. But access to the most capable AI is centralized, and anything centralized can be taken away. DII asks a simple question: how do we keep a dependable level of capable AI available to everyone, permanently, and beyond the reach of any single party's decision to switch it off?

WHAT HAPPENED, AND WHY IT MATTERS

In June 2026, the most capable AI models were switched off worldwide for about two weeks by government directive, then switched back on. Whatever one thinks of the reason, the episode proved something structural: access to today's most powerful AI can be revoked quickly, from above, by a party that is neither the user nor the company that built it. For anyone who has come to rely on these tools, "available for now" is a fragile foundation on which to build a livelihood, a business, or a country's capability.

THE IDEA, IN THE SPIRIT OF TOR

DII is modeled on Tor, the volunteer network that keeps private, uncensorable internet access available to everyone. Where Tor is sustained by people who run relays because they believe in it, DII aims to keep capable AI available through volunteers who run nodes: ordinary powerful computers running open AI models locally. No company owns it, there is nothing to buy, and there is no central server that anyone can shut off. People who cannot run a node themselves are served by the network, the way most people who use Tor never run a relay.

The promise is deliberately modest. DII does not try to match the frontier systems built by the major labs; that is their work, and DII operates alongside them. Its guarantee is narrower and more durable: an advanced-enough AI people can always rely on, running on equipment they own, that keeps working even if centralized access is cut off, priced out of reach, or restricted. It aims to be a dependable floor, like electricity, rather than an intermittent ceiling.

WHY IT MATTERS

- **Resilience and sovereignty:** community and national capability that cannot be revoked by a single actor or supply-chain shock.
- **Access and equity:** reaches people priced out of frontier subscriptions, or who cannot send sensitive data (patient, client, legal) to large cloud providers.
- **Reach:** can serve small businesses, libraries, and rural or remote communities, where reliable access is thinnest.

WHAT IT IS NOT

- **Not anti-government:** it accepts that some oversight is legitimate and does not distribute dangerous, frontier-level capability.
- **Not a business:** no product, no subscription, no token or marketplace.
- **Not a competitor** to the major AI labs. It is a complement, a safety net beneath them.

WHERE IT STANDS, AND AN OPEN DOOR

DII is early-stage, open research, shared publicly in the tradition of a request-for-comments: a documented design with research actively underway and a proof-of-concept planned. It is the kind of public-interest infrastructure that fits naturally with universities (distributed systems, digital sovereignty, and equitable access to technology) and with public institutions thinking about resilient, sovereign digital infrastructure. Conversations, collaborators, and introductions are all welcome.